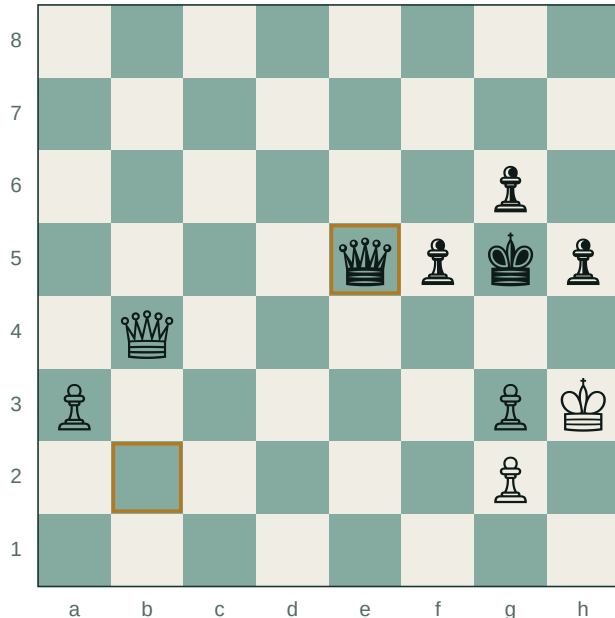


Queen-ending tactics: White, move 52

Queen-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 51...Qe5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

52. Qh4+ Kh6 53. Qf4+ Qxf4 54. gxf4

52.Qh4+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **52...Kh6**.

53.Qf4+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From f4 it attacks king on h6 and queen on e5. Recorded reply: **53...Qxf4**.

54.gxf4 The pawn captures the queen on f4.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on g5. Geometrically undefended: queen on e5. Check for tactical protection.